

SOW review checklist

Ten places risk most often hides in a Statement of Work. Tick each one before signature; anything unticked is a finding to raise.

Scope and deliverables

☐ **1. Deliverables are concrete and testable**

"A responsive site with these 12 named pages", not "a modern website". Vague deliverable language is the largest single source of scope creep.

☐ **2. Every deliverable has acceptance criteria**

A stated process for how it is reviewed and signed off. Without one, "done" is a matter of opinion.

☐ **3. Exclusions are stated explicitly**

What is not included is written down, not inferred from what is.

Timeline and process

☐ **4. A change-control clause exists**

Any scope addition goes through a written, priced amendment before work starts on it.

☐ **5. Milestones and dependencies are dated and owned**

Who delivers what, by when, is unambiguous.

☐ **6. Assumptions and client-side dependencies are listed**

Approvals, access and third-party data have owners and dates; a timeline that assumes instant client turnaround rarely survives.

Commercial and legal terms

☐ **7. A liability cap with a defined amount and carve-out list**

Or liability is explicitly unbounded and someone has accepted that.

☐ **8. Payment milestones are tied to deliverables**

Not calendar dates alone, so payment and delivery stay linked.

☐ **9. The MSA is referenced correctly**

The SOW does not quietly restate or contradict terms the MSA already covers; the order-of-precedence clause is known.

The final check

☐ **10. Read it as the other side would**

A SOW written entirely from one party's perspective has gaps the other party will surface later, during the project rather than before it.

ScopeWise runs this checklist, plus a deterministic rule engine and six specialist reviewers, on every uploaded SOW or RFP and quotes the clause behind each finding. <https://scopewise.assessiq.in/product/sow-review> · This checklist is guidance, not legal advice.